

Single-band or dual-band

Band is a frequently-used term when it comes to wireless routers. Wireless communication operates on 2.4GHz and 5GHz bands. While single-band routers are restricted to 2.4GHz frequency, dual-band routers operate on both 2.4GHz and 5GHz frequencies. For heavy usage, like file-streaming and gaming, 5GHz band is a good choice, as it is less crowded and delivers better internal-network performance.

However, it has a downside too. It has been observed that 5GHz band is not able to sustain signals at greater distances. So, a 5GHz router can work best for you if you have understood the distance factor, while placing the router in your home. In addition, you should also check what band your device supports, before you opt for a wireless router.

Router speed

This is yet another aspect that you have to keep in mind while buying the right router for your home as the speed of a router may vary. Gone are the days when 300Mbps was considered to be the standard speed for most wireless routers. With changing times and needs, the speed has been beefed up to about 1900Mbps.

Do not go by these numbers literally for determining the speed of your router. With interferences present in the room, it is highly unlikely that you will get the exact router speed mentioned on the router. The fact is that, the speed mentioned on routers denotes the speed for ideal conditions. So, even if you get half the speed of what has been claimed, it is good enough.

Also, do not mistake router speed for the speed of your Internet connection. The speed of your Internet connection depends

on the speed provided by your service provider. The speed of the router manages your internal network and helps in tasks like streaming music, file sharing and so on.

What is 802.11n

802.11n is the latest popular standard in the world of wireless routers. Whether you buy a single-band or dual-band router, an 802.11n router is something that you should look for. However, 802.11n draft is the thing of the past, and 802.11n is the new standard and can support non-802.11n wireless devices as well.

But, as they say, technology is never stagnant, so is the case with wireless routers. The latest is 802.11ac. It is the most recent wireless networking standard and is capable of providing almost 1Gbps throughput, given ideal conditions. It supports up to 500Mbps on a single-band as well as dual-band. This standard is under development and there are not many devices that support it.

Security standards

Most routers available in the market today provide WPA2-level security, which is by far the highest level. So, checking this standard should save you from any possible cyber crime. However, if you have kids around, it is good to have a router that offers parental control.

Some other points to consider

IPv6. Of course, we are living in IPv6 era, but we cannot forget that the transition has happened just recently. While buying a new router, do consider the fact that new standards have come in.

SD card slot and USB ports. For those who need external file sharing or printer sharing at home, a router with a USB port or an SD card slot can be a good choice. ●

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